organize and even react as colonial subjects with an ease they had previously not known. Although resentful of colonial rule, modern- day India owes much to British rule, both in the realm of ideas as well as institutions.

The British Indian Empire – or the Raj – left an entire infrastructure of institutions and personnel, which were inherited by the Indian state. In addition, Indian leaders and strategists inherited the world view of the Raj that went beyond looking only at the immediate periphery of South Asia and instead sought India's influence from the Gulf to South-East Asia and even beyond. The role for the Indian Empire envisaged by London left an indelible mark on New Delhi's post-Independence strategic thinking.

For the British, India was the heart of their global empire, the jewel in the British queen or king's crown. It provided both economic and military wherewithal as well as manpower for sustaining the empire in Africa, East Asia, the Pacific islands and the Caribbean. As historian Lawrence James points out, for over a hundred years, the Indian Empire had 'underpinned' Britain's global power status by providing it with 'markets, prestige and muscle'.[32]

India was both a low-cost producer as well as a market for British products. The British Indian army was critical to maintaining British presence around the globe. In order to sustain Pax Britannica across the world, London believed it needed to maintain control of India. It sought to do this by defending its imperial policy both as a civilizing mission as well as one that kept the subcontinent from breaking apart due to communal or ethnic differences.

To understand the views of those who saw the Indian core of the empire as part of Britain's global civilizing mission one need only to turn to Philip Mason, author of the two-volume *The Men Who Ruled India.* For Mason, a former British Indian civil servant, people like him were akin to Plato's ideal philosopher-kings: the guardians who had been brought up and